MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • REGULATORY GOVERNANCE (MFS-GOV-05)

Safeguarding, Prevent Duty & Learner Welfare Policy

Protecting young people (16–18), vulnerable adults, and online learners through safe digital delivery, DBS governance, and welfare escalation.

Document Reference	MFS-GOV-05	**Effective Date**	11 November 2026
Quality & Centre Lead	Abdul (Head of Centre)	**Regulatory Alignment**	Keeping Children Safe in Education / Counter-Terrorism & Security Act 2015

1. Commitment to Online Learner Safety & Wellbeing

Master Functional Skills supports adult learners (19+), apprentices, and young people aged 16–18 across the UK. We are committed to maintaining a safe, respectful, and welfare-focused online tuition and examination environment free from abuse, harassment, exploitation, cyberbullying, or extremist radicalisation.

- **Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL):** Abdul (Head of Centre) serves as the Designated Safeguarding Lead, holding current Enhanced DBS clearance and Level 3 Designated Safeguarding Lead & Prevent Duty certification.
- **Safer Recruitment & Vetting:** All tutors, assessors, and remote invigilators undergo Enhanced DBS checks, identity/qualification verification, two professional references, and annual Safeguarding & Online Safety refresher training.

2. Safe Digital Tuition & Remote Invigilation Boundaries

Because Master Functional Skills operates primarily online, strict digital safeguarding boundaries protect both learners and staff:

Digital Safeguarding Control	Mandatory Operational Rule	Oversight & Audit
1-to-1 Tuition & SLC Recordings	Conducted exclusively via official MFS corporate video accounts; professional attire and neutral/blurred tutor backgrounds mandatory	Spot-checked during termly IQA & Quality Assurance audits
Learners Aged 16–17 & Adults at Risk	Parent/guardian or employer training coordinator copied into booking confirmations and safeguarding contact details	Verified at learner onboarding & registration
Direct Messaging Boundaries	Zero communication via personal social media accounts; all support routed via official MFS email and	Code of Conduct signed annually by all staff

	business channels	
Exam Anxiety & Welfare Triage	Invigilators trained to pause pre-exam onboarding if a learner experiences acute panic, offering calm rescheduling or rest-break review	Logged in Learner Welfare & Access Support Register

3. Recognising Concerns, Prevent Duty & Escalation SLA

Staff are trained to recognise disclosures or indicators of physical/emotional harm, domestic abuse, financial exploitation, severe exam distress, or radicalisation:

- **Immediate Risk of Harm (999):** Where any learner is in immediate danger, staff contact emergency services (999) immediately and notify the DSL within 1 hour.
- **Safeguarding Disclosure Logging (Within 4 Hours):** Staff listen non-judgementally without promising confidentiality, record exact learner words factually in the encrypted Safeguarding Log within 4 hours, and escalate to the DSL for local Multi-Agency Safeguarding Hub (MASH) or adult social care referral within 24 hours.
- **Prevent Duty & British Values:** Learning materials promote mutual respect, democracy, the rule of law, and individual liberty while equipping learners to evaluate online misinformation safely.

Document Control & Annual Governance Sign-Off

Approved By (Head of Centre & Quality Nominee):	Abdul — Master Functional Skills
Approval & Publication Date:	11 November 2026 (Version 2026.11)
Next Mandatory Annual Review Date:	11 November 2027 (or immediately upon Ofqual / Awarding Body update)